JAMES CHRISTOPHER HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Full Stack Engineer with 12 years of experience building scalable web applications and leading technical teams in fast-paced environments. I've spent the last 6 years at staff level, focusing on architecture decisions, mentoring junior developers, and delivering complex systems that handle millions of daily transactions. I'm particularly interested in solving performance bottlenecks and improving system reliability, and I enjoy working across the entire stack from database optimization to frontend user experience.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Python, Java, Go, Node.js, C++

Frontend: React, Vue.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Kubernetes

Tools and Frameworks: Django, Spring Boot, Express.js, GraphQL, REST APIs

DevOps: CI/CD pipelines, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Terraform, Ansible

Other: Microservices architecture, Event-driven systems, System design, SQL optimization

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Full Stack Engineer

Vertex Technologies Ltd

www.vertextech.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Architected and led development of a microservices platform serving 2 million active users across Europe, reducing API response times by 60 percent through database query optimization and caching strategies.

Mentored a team of 8 engineers across backend and frontend domains, conducting code reviews, designing technical specifications, and establishing best practices that improved deployment frequency to 20 times per week.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and observability infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, enabling the team to identify and resolve production issues 40 percent faster than previously.

Led migration of monolithic application to Kubernetes-based microservices architecture over 18 months, resulting in 35 percent cost reduction and improved system scalability during peak traffic periods.

Senior Full Stack Engineer

DataFlow Systems

www.dataflowsystems.co

London, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Developed and maintained a real-time data processing platform handling 500 million events daily, built with Go backend services, React frontend, and PostgreSQL data stores across AWS infrastructure.

Designed and implemented GraphQL API layer that reduced client-side data fetching overhead by 45 percent and improved developer experience for 25 engineers consuming the service.

Established automated testing framework achieving 82 percent code coverage, reducing production bugs by 50 percent and enabling confident rapid deployments.

Collaborated with product and design teams to rebuild user-facing dashboard from legacy jQuery code to modern React architecture, improving page load times from 8 seconds to 1.2 seconds.

Full Stack Engineer

Creative Digital Solutions Ltd

www.creativedigital.net

Bristol, United Kingdom

September 2011 - May 2017

Built and deployed multiple web applications using Python Django and JavaScript, serving e-commerce and SaaS clients with user bases ranging from 10,000 to 500,000 monthly active users.

Implemented automated deployment pipelines using Jenkins and Ansible, reducing release cycles from quarterly to weekly and enabling teams to deploy changes with confidence.

Optimized database performance for high-traffic applications by analyzing slow query logs, creating appropriate indexes, and refactoring inefficient queries, achieving 65 percent improvement in peak load response times.

Contributed to open source projects and maintained internal development tools and libraries that were used across multiple product teams, improving developer productivity and code consistency.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2011